

AI Risk Assessment Template

3-Question Risk Screening Guide



1. What Data Am I Using?

Assess the sensitivity of the data used by your AI system.

Data Sensitivity Scale

Low Risk

- ☐ Publicly available data
- ☐ Anonymized data with no re-identification risk
- ☐ Aggregated data

Actions:

- Document data sources.
- Ensure compliance with privacy policies.

Moderate Risk

- ☐ Pseudonymized data
- ☐ Data with limited personal identifiers
- ☐ Data that could indirectly reveal sensitive information

Actions:

- Implement data minimization techniques.
- Use secure data storage and access controls.
- Conduct regular data audits.

High Risk

- ☐ Sensitive personal data (e.g., health, financial, biometric)
- ☐ Data revealing protected characteristics (e.g., race, religion, sexual orientation)
- ☐ Data used for critical decisions affecting individuals' lives

Actions:

- Obtain explicit consent for data processing.
- Implement strong data encryption and access controls.
- Conduct a thorough privacy impact assessment.
- Consult with legal and ethics experts.

2. Who Could Be Affected?

Identify potential stakeholders and assess the impact on them.

Impact Assessment Scale

Low Impact

Description:

Minimal or no negative impact on individuals or groups.

Examples:

- Improved efficiency with no change in outcomes.
- Personalized product recommendations.

Actions:

- Monitor outcomes for unintended consequences.
- Provide clear explanations of AI system functionality.

Moderate Impact

Description:

Potential for some negative impact on individuals or groups.

Examples:

- Bias in customer service chatbots.
- Errors in automated content moderation.

Actions:

- Implement bias detection and mitigation techniques.
- Establish redress mechanisms for affected individuals.
- Provide human oversight of AI system decisions.

High Impact

Description:

Potential for significant and widespread negative impact on individuals or groups.

Examples:

- Discrimination in hiring or lending decisions.
- Errors in medical diagnoses or treatment recommendations.

Actions:

- Conduct rigorous testing and validation of AI system.
- Establish clear accountability and oversight mechanisms.
- Consult with stakeholders and experts on potential impacts.
- Have a 'kill switch' if things go wrong.

3. What Could Go Wrong?

Evaluate potential consequences and risks associated with the AI system.

Consequence Evaluation

Low Consequence

Examples:

- Minor inconvenience or annoyance.
- Slight inaccuracies in results.

Actions:

- Document potential risks and mitigation strategies.
- Regularly monitor system performance.

Moderate Consequence

Examples:

- Financial loss or reputational damage.
- Privacy breaches.

Actions:

- Implement incident response plan.
- Conduct regular security assessments.
- Establish data breach notification procedures.

High Consequence

Examples:

- Physical harm or loss of life.

- Systemic discrimination or injustice.

Actions:

- Implement robust safety measures and safeguards.
- Establish independent oversight and audit mechanisms.
- Develop ethical guidelines and codes of conduct.
- Halt development until risks are addressed.

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